



Handout 5.13: Cost Per Wear Worksheet and Quality Inspection Checklist

Name: _____ Date: _____ Station: _____

The formula: cost per wear = price divided by the number of times worn. The answer is in dollars per wear.

Word bank: price, wear, divide, seam, thread, button, strong Spanish: precio, uso, dividir, costura, hilo, botón, fuerte

Part 1. The three worked problems

Show the division. Write the unit on every answer.

(a) The jeans. A pair of jeans costs \$60. You wear them 200 times before they wear out.

$$\$60 \div 200 \text{ wears} = \$______ \text{ per wear}$$

(b) The shirt. A shirt costs \$15. You wore it 5 times. Then you stopped wearing it.

$$\$15 \div 5 \text{ wears} = \$______ \text{ per wear}$$

(c) The coat. A winter coat costs \$90. You wear it for 3 winters.

First you have to estimate (make a careful guess). How many times do you wear a winter coat in one winter? _____ times

$$\text{So 3 winters is } 3 \times ______ = ______ \text{ wears}$$

$$\$90 \div ______ \text{ wears} = \$______ \text{ per wear}$$

Which of the three cost the most per wear? _____

Which one had the lowest price? _____

Write one sentence: what do those two answers together tell you?

Part 2. What makes a garment last

For each factor, fill in what a good one looks like and what a fail looks like.

Factor	What to look for	A good one	A fail
1. Fiber	Read the label. What is it made of? What are the percentages?		
2. Seam type	Look inside. One row of stitching, two rows, or a raw edge wrapped inside?		
3. Stitches per inch	Put the ruler on a seam and count one inch.	_____ per inch is good	_____ per inch is low
4. Reinforcement at stress points	Look where the body pulls: pocket corners, belt loops, underarms, knees, where a strap joins.		

5. Buttons and closures	Pull the button gently. Run the zipper.		
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Seam words to know

- **Single-needle seam:** one row of stitching. It is the first seam to open.
- **Double-needle seam:** two parallel rows. It holds much better.
- **Flat felled seam:** the raw edges are folded and wrapped inside, then stitched through. It is the strongest of the three. Look at the outside side seam of a pair of jeans.
- **Serged edge:** thread looped over the raw edge to stop it from fraying. That is a finish, not a seam. A serged edge alone does not hold two pieces together.
- **Bar tack:** a short, dense line of stitches at a stress point, like the corner of a pocket.
- **Stress point:** anywhere the body pulls on the garment.

Part 3. Quality inspection, four garments

Run all five checks on each garment your station gets. Check the box if the result is good. Write the number where a number is asked for.

Garment 1: _____

Check	Finding	Good?
Fiber (from the label)		[]
Seam type (single, double, flat felled, or serged only)		[]
Stitches per inch	_____ per inch	[]
Reinforcement at a stress point (name the point)		[]
Buttons and closures		[]

One sentence: this garment will or will not last, because _____

Garment 2: _____

Check	Finding	Good?
Fiber (from the label)		[]
Seam type		[]
Stitches per inch	_____ per inch	[]
Reinforcement at a stress point (name the point)		[]
Buttons and closures		[]

One sentence: this garment will or will not last, because _____

Garment 3: _____

Check	Finding	Good?
Fiber (from the label)		[]
Seam type		[]
Stitches per inch	_____ per inch	[]
Reinforcement at a stress point (name the point)		[]
Buttons and closures		[]

One sentence: this garment will or will not last, because _____

Garment 4: _____

Check	Finding	Good?
Fiber (from the label)		[]
Seam type		[]
Stitches per inch	_____ per inch	[]
Reinforcement at a stress point (name the point)		[]
Buttons and closures		[]

One sentence: this garment will or will not last, because _____

My ranking

Rank the four garments. 1 is most likely to last. 4 is least likely. Write one reason for each rank.

Rank	Garment	Reason
1		
2		
3		
4		

Part 4. The trade-off: price now against cost over time

Two garments, two different people. Compute cost per wear for both.

Garment 1, the heavy sweatshirt: \$44. Garment 2, the thin t-shirt: \$8.

Person 1: a student who walks to school and will wear it four days a week for two winters

About how many wears in two winters? _____ wears

Garment	Price	Wears	Cost per wear
The \$8 t-shirt	\$8		\$
The \$44 sweatshirt	\$44		\$

Verdict, one sentence: _____

Person 2: someone who needs a shirt for one concert

About how many wears? _____ wears

Garment	Price	Wears	Cost per wear
The \$8 t-shirt	\$8		\$
The \$44 sweatshirt	\$44		\$

Verdict, one sentence: _____

The point in your own words: cost per wear only answers the question once you know _____.

Exit card

3 things you would check on a garment before buying it:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

2 cost-per-wear numbers you computed today, with units:

\$_____ per wear and \$_____ per wear

1 item in your own closet that you now think was a good buy or a bad buy, and why, in six words:

Answer: _____

Grade 8 stretch (optional, on the back)

1. An \$8 t-shirt is worn 10 times. At what number of wears does the \$44 sweatshirt become cheaper per wear than that t-shirt? Show your work.
2. The \$8 t-shirt survives 10 washes. The \$44 sweatshirt survives 100. You need a sweatshirt for 100 washes. (a) What does each option cost you in total? (b) Which is cheaper?
3. Pick a coat you own. Estimate its price and the wears per winter. What is its cost per wear per winter?